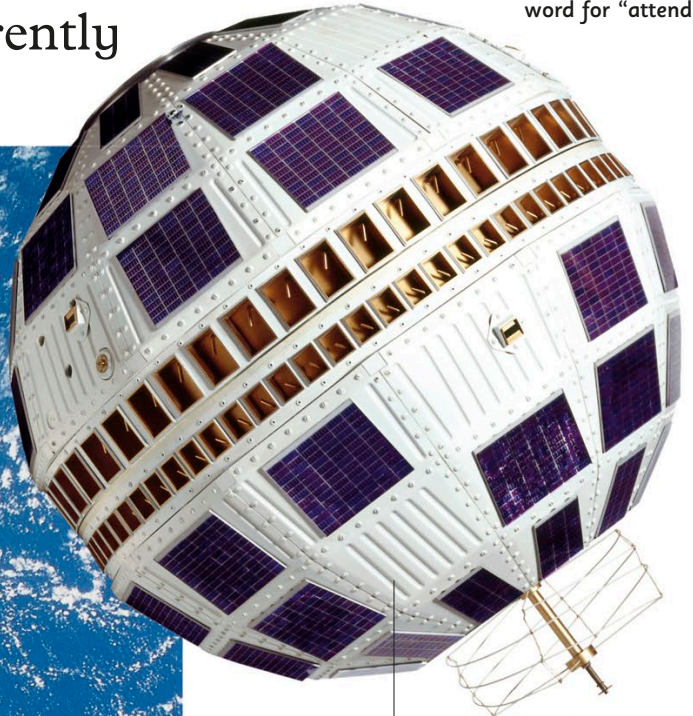
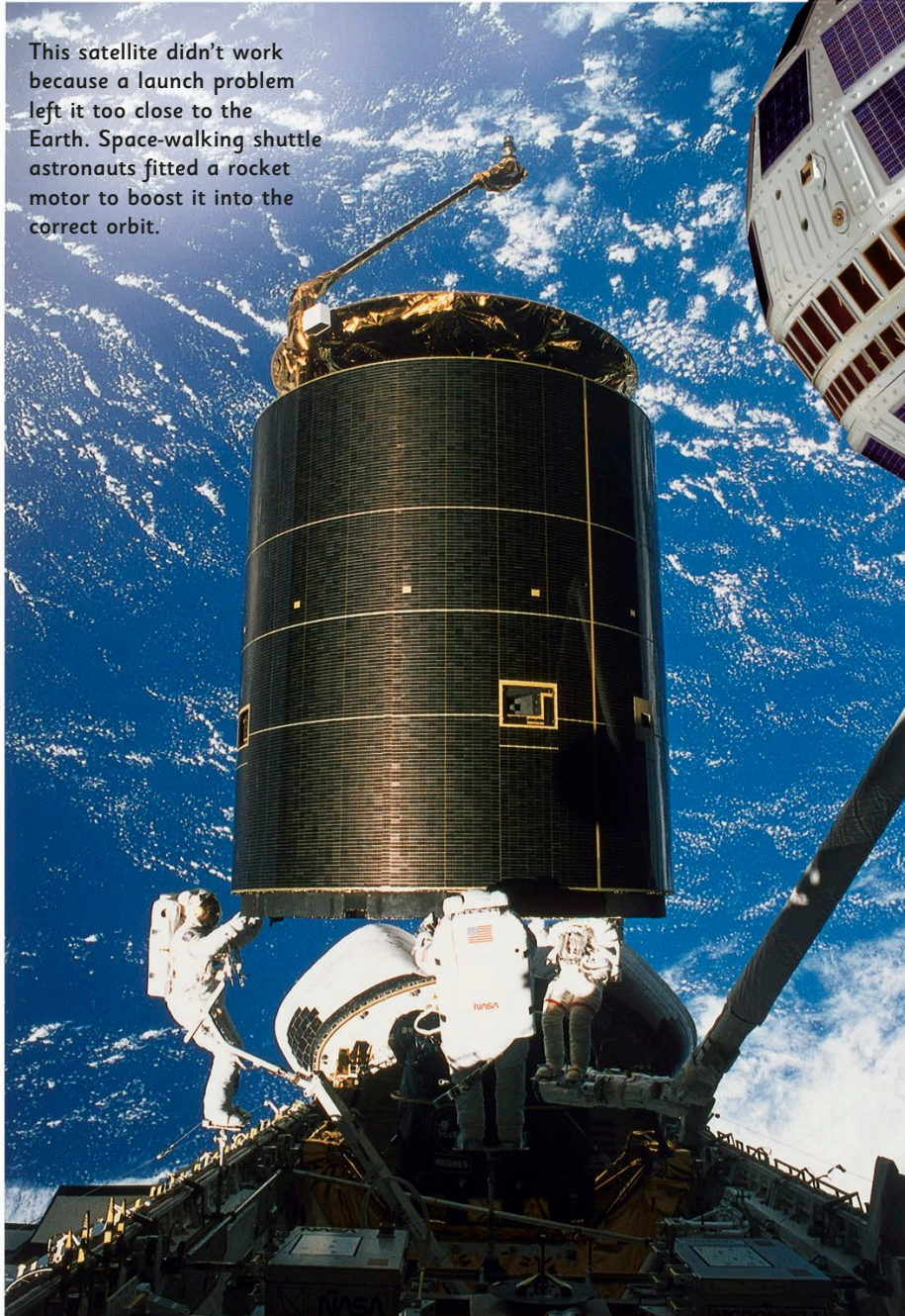


# Artificial satellites

A satellite is an object, natural or man-made, that orbits something bigger than itself. The Moon is the Earth's natural satellite, but thousands of man-made satellites are currently orbiting our Earth as well.

The word "satellite" comes from the Latin word for "attendant".

This satellite didn't work because a launch problem left it too close to the Earth. Space-walking shuttle astronauts fitted a rocket motor to boost it into the correct orbit.



The *Telstar* satellite relayed the first satellite television signal in 1962.

Domestic satellite dishes receive the signals sent by television satellites.



## Space litter

Of the thousands of artificial satellites currently orbiting the Earth, many are no longer working. Bits and parts that have fallen off other satellites or rockets are also floating around in space.